# Finch trapping: what did Brussels write?

*A news report of the Commission's October 2025 letter, tested against the letter*

THE CLAIM

## *"That request still stands."*

**European Commission, DG Environment, letter to BirdLife Malta, October 2025**

Speaker's own words, English text of the letter.

*We read the letter itself, a copy published by BirdLife Malta, and compared it with Italpress's report.*

VERDICT

## LARGELY SUPPORTED

*Accurate on the notice and referral; "in breach" is the outlet's wording.*

SUPPORTED | **LARGELY SUPPORTED** | NOT SUBSTANTIATED | MISLEADING | CONTRADICTED

## MAIN RESULTS

### Still stands

**Formal notice, Feb 2025**

The Commission's own words on its request that Malta implement the Court's ruling.

### May refer

**Possible next step**

The letter names referral to the Court of Justice as a possible enforcement step.

### 0

**"In breach" in the letter**

The phrase is Italpress's. The letter says the new derogation "seems similar" to the 2024 one and is being assessed.

### 393 days

**Judgment to new derogation**

From the Court's ruling of 19 Sep 2024 to the rules adopted on 17 Oct 2025.

### Not read

**The 2025 rules and the new notice**

BirdLife Malta reports a new formal notice on 21 Nov 2025; we have not read it.

### FAIR TO SAY

We rate the statements reported, not hunters, NGOs or officials.

## WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

- ☐ The Commission's notice INFR(2025)2128.
- ☐ The 17 Oct 2025 rules and the Government's reasoning.
- ☐ The Commission's own copy of the letter.